

Intel pays NVIDIA

NVIDIA has signed a cross licensing fee with Intel for a period of six years for a fee of \$1.5 billion

New profile for everyone

Facebook which allowed users to choose between new profile and the old one, has not upgraded everyone to the new profile.

Bazaar

Asus O!Play HD2

HD Media Players, redefined

Vishal Mathur

The new Asus O!Play HD2 Media Player walks the path of trying to offer a lot of features in one box. The glossy black body is a fingerprint and scratch magnet. The front panel has the memory card slot and a USB input, making it look a little shabby.

It definitely looks much bigger than the WD Live Hub. However, the HD2 is capable of holding a 3.5 inch hard drive, which you buy separately, as against the 1TB 2.5-inch which WD have pre-installed in the Live Hub.

It supports USB 3.0 standard, making it future proof. Internet connectivity offers widgets like Flickr, YouTube and also the ability to download torrents. You can also control HD2 via an iPhone app.

The HD2 takes about 14 seconds to start up. The interface is not very sleek - a circular design paired with huge icons. All videos, be it SD 720p HD and 1080p HD play perfectly. The colours, after the upscale treatment did not feel washed or faded. Dark scenes looked good. Movie load time floats



between 2 seconds and 3.2 seconds, depending on the file size and resolution. There was a slight stutter in fast moving scenes. The remote is a huge improvement over the one offered with the predecessor, the Asus O!Play HD.

At a price of ₹8,000, the O!Play HD2 offers an excellent HD video experience and the goodness of torrents.

Specifications

Ports : HDMI 1.3, Composite and Component video; Resolution : 1080p; Internet widgets : YouTube, Flickr, Picassa, etc; Torrent support : Yes

Contact

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Web site: www.asus.in
Price: ₹8,000

7.5
10

Features.....	9.0
Performance.....	7.0
Build Quality.....	7.0
Value for money.....	7.0

Sony NWZ E454

Well rounded mid-range PMP

Siddharth Parwatay

The NWZ E454 is the latest Walkman series PMP that we go our hands on. In terms of looks, it seems to be a watered down reincarnation of the NWZ A845, that we tested some time ago. However, the device is big on features which include Lyrics support, variable playback speed, sectional looping for learning languages, Karaoke, and SenseMe that analyses songs into categories like upbeat, energetic etc for mood-based playback. Not all of the features work as well as they should and are a little tedious to use. For instance the SenseMe feature requires analysis of files through a 12

tone analysis process while they're being transferred; which obviously takes longer and is about 70% accurate. We received the black variant and the player doesn't look bad at all. Build quality is pretty good but the finish of the plastic is slippery - an inadvertent drop test or two nearly happened until we got used to gripping it more firmly. As far quality, the playback on our current reference headphones (HD 428s) left us with nothing to complain about. The bundled ear phones how-



ever are one of those hard plastic buds, which not everyone likes. That is not to say they were bad in terms of sound reproduction, just lacked a little comfort and noise isolation. The UI is very friendly and intuitive, reaffirming the belief that it's not just Apple that can make good UIs. At a price of ₹6,990 this is a good PMP and competes well with the likes of Creative's Zen X-Fi Style.

7.5
10

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Performance.....	7.0
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Contact

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Price: ₹6,990